Final reflections

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Final reflections
Tuesday, 3 November 2026, 8:41 AM

Please reflect upon your experiences in this workshop and post a farewell address to your facilitator and fellow participants.



Re: Final reflections
by Aminurrashid Bin Abu Bakar - Tuesday, 3 November 2026, 8:48 AM

Congratulations, everyone! 🎉

You made it!

Congratulations on reaching the end of our DP Physics Category 1 workshop! It's been quite a journey over these four weeks, and I want to thank you for all the thoughtful contributions, discussions, and experiences you've shared with us. I hope you've found the workshop useful and picked up a few ideas to bring back to your own classrooms.

One final task: Share your reflections!

Before you sign off, I'd love for you to take a few minutes to share with the rest of us **how you found the workshop**. What did you enjoy? What did you learn? Is there anything you're looking forward to trying in your classroom?

Nothing lengthy needed, just a quick reflection in the **Final reflections** discussion forum below. We've learned so much from each other over the past four weeks, so it would be lovely to hear your final thoughts!

End-of-course survey

You'll soon receive an email inviting you to complete the end-of-course survey. Please do take a few minutes to respond. Your feedback is valuable and helps improve future workshops.

Let's keep in touch!

Just because the workshop is ending doesn't mean we have to lose touch! I still keep in contact with the very first workshop session leader (WSL) I met about 15 years ago, and over the years, we've become good friends.

And a little apology from me if I haven't managed to get to all your questions. There were some really good ones. Please don't be a stranger. If there's something you'd still like to discuss, or if you need anything down the road, feel free to reach out. I'm always happy to continue the conversation.

You've already got my email, but I'm also happy to share my WhatsApp and LinkedIn if you'd like to stay connected:

WhatsApp: +62 877 1717 1719

LinkedIn: Connect with me on LinkedIn

I'd love to hear how things go in your classrooms, and perhaps we'll cross paths again at another workshop or conference someday!

If you're interested in joining another IB workshop in the future, you can explore the available courses on the **IB professional development website**.

Thank you once again for being part of this journey. It's been a pleasure learning alongside you, and I wish you all the very best with your DP Physics teaching!

Take care, and please do keep in touch! 😊

Amin

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Tuesday, 3 November 2026, 10:04 PM

As IB CAT 1 comes to a close, I want to take a moment to say thank you.

To Mr Amin: Thank you for your guidance, patience, and clear teaching throughout this course. You made difficult topics easier to understand and created a space where we felt comfortable asking questions. Your dedication has made a real difference to all of us.

To my fellow participants: It was a pleasure learning alongside you. Whether through discussions, group work, or the shared stress of deadlines, you made this experience richer and a lot more enjoyable. I've valued your insights and your support, and I hope we stay in touch.

I'm leaving with new knowledge, new connections, and a lot of appreciation for the time we spent together. I wish everyone success in the next steps of their journey, and I hope our paths cross again.

With sincere thanks and best wishes,
[redacted]

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Tuesday, 3 November 2026, 11:22 PM

Hi Amin,
This workshop helped me understand the structure of IBDP programs in general and the IBDP Physics course in particular. I understand that being a workshop leader, along with working full-time as a teacher, can be a very daunting task, and I am amazed by your spirit in conducting this workshop. Following up with every candidate, reading their responses, and providing feedback might have been frustrating sometimes, but you carried on with both warmth and punctuality.
This workshop made me acquainted with the new curriculum and helped me refresh the basic demands of the school curricula in general.

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Wednesday, 4 November 2026, 3:57 AM

Dear Amin and fellow participants,

Thank you so much, Amin, for your outstanding leadership, encouragement, and thoughtful guidance throughout these four weeks!

Reflecting back on this Category 1 workshop, it has been an incredibly enriching journey. A few key highlights that stand out for me include:

- **Navigating the 2025/2027 Guide & Criterion E:** Gaining a much deeper understanding of how evaluative reflection (RPF) works under the updated guide, particularly shifting from descriptive logs to meaningful evaluation of growth and scientific resilience.

- **Course Design & ATL Integration:** Structuring a comprehensive course outline that seamlessly connects core topics with practical lab hours, Theory of Knowledge (TOK), and real-world global contexts.
- **Community Collaboration:** Reading everyone's diverse insights, sharing practical strategies for IAs and EEs, and seeing how different schools implement inquiry-based physics teaching worldwide.

I am really looking forward to bringing these ideas back to my classroom—especially embedding explicit research and metacognitive skills early in Year 1 practicals and using inquiry-driven routines to prepare students for independent investigations.

Thank you all for sharing your expertise and experiences. It has been a true privilege learning alongside such a dedicated group of educators.

Let's definitely stay in touch! Wishing everyone the very best with their DP Physics teaching and the upcoming academic term.

Warm regards,

[redacted]

[redacted]

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Wednesday, 4 November 2026, 10:49 PM

Hello everyone! Completing this workshop has been a very positive experience for me. As someone who is still developing their experience with the IB Physics programme, I have gained a much better understanding of the curriculum, assessment requirements, Internal Assessment expectations, and the resources available through My IB and the PRC.

What I found most valuable was learning from the experiences of colleagues from different schools and countries. The discussions, shared ideas, and practical examples gave me plenty of inspiration that I can take back to my own classroom.

Thank you to Amin and all participants for creating such a supportive and collaborative learning environment.

One suggestion, if others agree, would be to create a shared document where participants can voluntarily leave a school or professional email address if they wish to stay in contact after the workshop. I understand the importance of privacy and personal data, so participation would be entirely optional, but it could be a nice way to continue exchanging ideas, resources, and advice with fellow IB educators in the future.

Many thanks,

[redacted]

[redacted]

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Wednesday, 4 November 2026, 10:49 PM

Dear Amin and fellow participants,

As a relatively new teacher, I have gained a wealth of new knowledge and experience from this workshop. I have developed a better understanding of the IB framework—from the IB Learner Profile and the approach to teaching Physics within the IB curriculum, to various fundamental concepts that I was previously unfamiliar with.

I also truly valued hearing the diverse perspectives of my fellow Physics teachers. I learned a great deal from the experiences shared and the discussions held throughout this workshop; all of it has significantly broadened my insight into teaching and learning in a school setting.

Thank you all for the knowledge, experiences, and advice you have shared. My thanks also go to Amin, our facilitator, for guiding us throughout this workshop.

Best regards,

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Tuesday, 3 November 2026, 12:53 PM

Dear Facilitator and Fellow Participants,

Thank you for an informative and rewarding workshop. I enjoyed learning alongside other Physics teachers and gained a clearer understanding of IB teaching, course planning and practical investigations. I look forward to using more collaborative learning, reflection and open-ended practical work with my students. I wish you all continued success in your teaching.

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Tuesday, 3 November 2026, 3:17 PM

I want to express my appreciation for our facilitator and all my fellow participants for generously sharing your insights and best practices. I enjoyed reading a variety of perspectiv. Since it is my first year, at some point joining the DP was overwhelming but having this kind of community helped me understand how TOK, CAS and EE should be incorporated in my physics content. As well as on how I can support the students in linking concepts/skills acquired in other disciplines. This workshop has helped me develop a clearer understanding the philosophy behind DP. The first learning engagement on the first module peaked my interest. I have read some of the course outlines (and hope to finish browsing it all for inspiration) and have adapted learning experience ideas for my class. I am looking forward to upgrade my course outline in a framework that would incorporate TOK, to add context that would peak the students' engagement and to address all skills that students would need in their assessments.

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Tuesday, 3 November 2026, 5:24 PM

Dear Facilitator and Fellow Participants,
As a Cambridge physics teacher, this workshop gave me a clear picture of how IBDP physics differs. The most useful parts were studying the exam papers and their question types, building a full course outline for SL and HL, and understanding the EE supervisor’s role and the new reflection criterion. I now see how much the IB values inquiry, the IA, the EE and TOK links alongside content. I still want to learn more about applying the grade descriptors and boundaries to my students’ work, and I plan to use the ATL tool again after my first IB unit. The facilitator was supportive and engaging throughout, and that made it easy to learn and ask questions. Thank you to the facilitator and my fellow participants.

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Tuesday, 3 November 2026, 9:03 PM

This course was a truly engaging and memorable experience for me, and I’ve learned so much. I especially enjoyed seeing other participants' work on the forum and considering each topic from different perspectives. I’m excited to try out many of these shared methods and ideas in my own classroom. Thank you to the organizers for your hard work, and to my colleagues for your detailed and insightful forum posts. Wishing you all the very best!

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Wednesday, 4 November 2026, 7:10 AM

Dear facilitator and fellow participants,

As this workshop comes to an end, I would like to thank you all for this valuable learning experience.

Coming from the French education system, I started with many questions about how an IB Physics course is structured. Developing my course outline helped me better understand the IB framework and gave me a clearer direction.

I particularly appreciated the feedback from my colleagues and facilitator, which helped me improve my course plan, incorporate more practical and TOK activities, and better balance the distribution of topics across the two years.

Thank you for sharing your knowledge, experiences, and ideas. I wish you all the best with your courses and your students!

Warm regards,
[redacted]

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Wednesday, 4 November 2026, 7:30 AM

Dear Amin and all participants,
Thank you for all your feedback, insights and sharing your experiences and expertise. I started the year out with two IB classes and was not trained and limited resources at the time. I had many questions and needed direction and resources to navigate this new program. I am now more knowledgeable and a bit more confident in teaching this program. And Amin, knowing that there's still some support afterwards is comforting. I know that as I get more confident and involved in developing lessons and teaching more questions might come up. Thank you again, you have been a great facilitator.

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Wednesday, 4 November 2026, 9:45 AM

Final reflections

Four weeks ago I walked in knowing how to teach physics. I'm leaving knowing how to teach the DP — and honestly, the gap between those two things was bigger than I expected.

A few things that stuck:

The ATL self-assessment was the most uncomfortable and therefore the most valuable task. My "audit" made it embarrassingly obvious that I teach inquiry well and teach research skills barely at all. My IA prep has been quietly carrying the entire research-skills load without me ever naming it. That's a fixable problem, and it's already on next unit's plan.

What I enjoyed most, though, was the discussion forum itself. Reading how colleagues in different countries handle the same practicals, the same marking pile, the same nervous first IA cohort — you can't get that from a subject guide.

What I'm looking forward to trying: more open-ended inquiry in my units, being deliberate about global contexts (energy and climate give me no excuse), and actually administering the ATL reflection to my students rather than just auditing myself.

Thank you to our facilitator for the steady pacing and generous feedback — and to everyone who posted their real classroom experiences. This didn't feel like a course; it felt like joining a department that happens to span the world.

Signing off, and seeing my own classroom a little differently than I did a month ago.

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Wednesday, 4 November 2026, 11:18 AM

The workshop provided a deeper understanding of the IB philosophy and how it can be translated into effective classroom practices in DP Physics. It reinforced the importance of inquiry-based and concept-driven learning, encouraging students to question, investigate, connect concepts and apply their understanding to real-world situations. I gained valuable insights into using guiding and linking questions to establish conceptual connections across different areas of Physics and planning meaningful practical activities to strengthen experimental skills and scientific thinking.

The sessions on internal and external assessment enhanced my understanding of assessment criteria, command terms, examination question formats and the importance of providing constructive feedback. I also developed a clearer perspective on guiding students through the Physics Extended Essay, maintaining academic integrity and supporting independent research. The Collaborative Sciences Project highlighted the value of interdisciplinary learning and teamwork in addressing real-world challenges.

Overall, the workshop encouraged me to reflect on my teaching practices and plan a more integrated, student-centred DP Physics programme. I look forward to incorporating these approaches into my classroom to nurture curious, reflective and independent learners with strong conceptual understanding and scientific skills

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Thursday, 5 November 2026, 2:12 AM

Hi Amin,
One more thing that I would like to highlight is that, as I am not an IDBP teacher at the moment, I do not have a MyIB account. Therefore, I was not able to download the documents and resources for which the MyIB link was shared. As it was advertised on the workshop (ibo.org) website that the teachers who are not teaching in an IB school can also join the workshop, it was expected that resources would be provided directly. Furthermore, the last task of Module 4 wanted us to go through the MyIB website to explore the resources available, but I couldn't finish that task as I did not have access to that website.

I suggest that IB provide temporary access to the website when a task requires it.

Finally, I would like to thank you for being available via email to provide the requested resources and add a personal touch to my IBDP learning journey. I wish to meet you again at another workshop or perhaps face-to-face. Take care and keep in touch.
[redacted]

Re: Final reflections

by [redacted] - Thursday, 5 November 2026, 6:16 PM

Thank you everyone for this workshop! I have learned a lot about the IB Physics programme. The discussions and shared ideas were very helpful, especially as my school will start the IB programme next year.

I know I still have a lot to learn, but I feel more confident and better prepared now. Thank you to our facilitator for the support and to all participants for sharing your experiences and ideas.

I wish you all the best!